

Mark Park

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Dear Hiring Manager,

For the past four-plus years I've been embedded on Franklin Templeton engineering teams as a Brillio contractor, and I'm applying to join the firm full time. In that time I've taken three enterprise financial microservices from proof of concept through production, most recently as Lead Software Engineer of a five-engineer team rebuilding the platform that onboards the firm's ultra-high-net-worth clients — a launch leadership recognized as a turnaround of a system users and stakeholders had previously criticized. I did this having started with no financial-systems background; I taught myself how banking, settlement, and compliance work — partly through the architects who mentored me, and largely through self-study.

What I think distinguishes my record is that every step of it was pulled, not pushed. I joined as a contractor; delivery on my first project earned a two-year extension. The lead architect then hand-picked me to build the base architecture for a second product. Senior architects and my manager recommended me for the lead role on the flagship rebuild, and Brillio converted me from contractor to full-time employee in June 2025. I was also pulled back onto an older transaction system specifically to help lift it from Java 8 to Java 21, applying migration work I'd just led elsewhere. Each advancement came from people I'd delivered for asking to keep working with me.

That ownership extended to production itself. On the transaction-processing system I became one of its two primary maintainers during live market hours, watching over a process moving tens of millions of dollars a day that is unusually fragile — time-dependent and strict on data, such that any missed window or incomplete information meant a restart or a push to the next business day's settlement. We never let a transaction spill over: we coordinated coverage down to staggered lunches so one of us was always available, and worked in real time with teams across the firm to post and settle through FIS Global Plus, our multi-currency portfolio accounting and trust custody platform.

I lead the way I was mentored: staying hands-on while growing the people around me. On the current rebuild I architected the platform's two core microservices myself while running technical design discussions across cross-functional groups of 20–30, and mentored a summer intern with no enterprise Java experience through shipping several production APIs. I bring the rigor of regulated finance — KYC and OFAC compliance, government audit trails, systems where eliminating production deadlocks entirely is a requirement rather than an achievement — and hold my team to that same bar.

I've also made AI-assisted development central to how I work, and I've built real discipline around it rather than just speed. Since Franklin Templeton rolled out GitHub Copilot firm-wide in January 2026, I've ranked in the top 5% on cost-efficiency — prompt spend versus code accepted — with over 30,000 lines of AI-assisted code accepted into production. The practice I built around it is test-driven at its core: I write test suites from business requirements first, direct agents to implement against them, and gate every change behind agent-driven code review and agent-authored pull requests via GitHub MCP on Copilot CLI — with a standing rule that existing functional tests are never broken. I packaged that discipline into a shared copilot-instructions.md, custom CLI commands with Jira integration, commit-message conventions built for future searchability, and a database-alignment tool other teams now use — then ran knowledge-transfer sessions on prompt and loop engineering that onboarded my whole AOP 2.0 team and the leads of CashApp and SWP Forms. I first taught myself these agentic workflows on my own time with Claude Code — parallel instances via git worktrees, prompt and loop engineering — and as soon as GitHub Copilot CLI was enabled at the firm I translated those concepts onto the approved tooling, which is also what let me extend confidently beyond backend into front-end and DevOps work.

One practical note: I'm based in California and have worked full Eastern-time hours since 2022, starting my day at 6 AM Pacific. I'm open to the New York hybrid arrangement or a California office, whichever suits the team.

My resume is attached with further detail. I'd welcome the chance to talk about how I can contribute to your team.

Sincerely,
Mark Park